hours of our son being born we were back at Frogmore. The sun had risen and we were behind closed doors before the official announcement was released…

Saying Meg had gone into labor?

I had a tiff with Sara about that. You know she's not in labor anymore, I said.

She explained that the press must be given the dramatic, suspenseful story they demanded.

But it's not true, I said.

Ah, truth didn't matter. Keeping people tuned to the show, that was the thing.

After a few hours I was standing outside the stables at Windsor, telling the world: It's a boy. Days later we announced the name to the world. Archie.

The papers were incensed. They said we'd pulled a fast one on them.

Indeed we had.

They felt that, in doing so, we'd been…bad partners?

Astonishing. Did they still think of us as partners? Did they really expect special consideration, preferential treatment—given how they'd treated us these last three years?

And then they showed the world what kind of "partners" they really were. A BBC radio presenter posted a photo on his social media—a man and a woman holding hands with a chimpanzee.

The caption read: *Royal baby leaves hospital.*

66.

I HAD A LONG TEA WITH GRANNY, just before she left for Balmoral. I gave her a recap, all the latest. She knew a bit, but I was filling in important gaps.

She looked shocked.

Appalling, she said.

She vowed to send the Bee to talk to us.

I'd spent my life dealing with courtiers, scores of them, but now I dealt mostly with just three, all middle-aged white men who'd managed to consolidate power through a series of bold Machiavellian maneuvers. They had